TALENT MARKET MAPPING

Enterprise AI, GenAI & SaaS

Nidhi Kuntal

THE ASSIGNMENT AND APPROACH

I built this study to understand how a recruitment consultant could convert a broad client requirement into a focused search and a defensible candidate shortlist. The workflow was: segment employers → compare roles and skills → define a sample job order → plan sourcing and screening → identify potential client accounts. This is desk research and a recruitment simulation, not a claim of live requisitions, candidate interviews or placements.

Market scope	Research output
44 companies	Enterprise technology employers mapped by business segment, India hub and role relevance
7 role families / 21 skills	Cross-role comparison of capabilities and screening priorities
1 illustrative job order	Associate GenAI Engineer, with must-have/preferred criteria
10 prospect accounts	Provisional ranking for further client development research

WHAT I FOUND — AND WHAT IT MEANS FOR SOURCING

Bengaluru appears as the primary India hub for 20 of 44 mapped companies (45%); Chennai, Mumbai, Hyderabad, NCR and Pune follow in the selected sample. This is a feature of the researched list, not an estimate of the national hiring market. My role-relevance mapping connects ML/MLOps with 39 employers and GenAI/LLM Engineering with 38. These matches suggest where to investigate talent and possible demand; they do not represent verified openings.

The actionable insight is that "AI experience" is too broad a keyword. For technical shortlisting, demonstrated Python delivery, APIs, retrieval quality and production ownership are more useful than tool-name matching alone. Recruiter screens should therefore ask what the person built, how it was evaluated and which part they personally owned.

ILLUSTRATIVE CLIENT JOB ORDER

Client X is a hypothetical B2B SaaS employer. The position below is a sample recruiting brief, not an advertised vacancy.

Field	Search definition
Role and logistics	Associate GenAI Engineer | Bengaluru hybrid | ~1–3 years | 2 illustrative openings
Must-have	Python; built an LLM-based application; retrieval/RAG; REST APIs; Git; deployment fundamentals
Preferred	LangChain/LlamaIndex; LLM evaluation; LoRA/PEFT; Docker/CI/CD; SaaS/product exposure
Confirm before launch	Compensation band, notice-period ceiling, interview steps, hiring manager, vendor approval

CANDIDATE QUALIFICATION: A REPEATABLE STANDARD

Start with a 15–20-minute screen for location/hybrid fit, availability, compensation and evidence of relevant delivery. Use the workbook's weighted skill matrix to organise technical evidence, but reject or escalate any missing non-negotiable rather than allowing a high total score to hide it. Document factual answers separately from the recruiter's assessment; follow the employer's SOP and privacy requirements.

Sample interview note (fictional): "2 years Python/FastAPI; built internal RAG assistant and explained citation handling. Bengaluru relocation: yes. Notice: self-reported 30 days. Deployment ownership unverified—request architecture walkthrough before submission."

SOURCING STRATEGY: FROM LONG LIST TO CLIENT SHORTLIST

Search the internal talent database and relevant referrals first, then publicly available LinkedIn profiles, GitHub portfolios and job boards. Save the candidate source, objective skill evidence, contact/outreach status and consent preferences. Avoid speculative personal data collection.

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Example Boolean search: ("GenAI" OR "LLM Engineer" OR "Generative AI") AND Python AND (RAG OR "vector database" OR LangChain) AND (Bengaluru OR Bangalore)
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If results are narrow, broaden titles to “AI Engineer” or backend engineers with credible RAG project work. Research potential feeder companies such as Yellow.ai, Observe.AI, Sarvam AI, Leena AI and Uniphore. Employer inclusion is not evidence that any individual is job-seeking.

Planning funnel (hypothetical)	Volume	Recruiter check
Profiles researched	200	Relevant experience and sourcing provenance
Personalised outreach	160	Demonstrated skill + role suitability
Candidate responses	40	Motivation, salary and timing
Interested candidate screens	20	Comparable notes; verify must-haves
Technical shortlist	8	Submit only with supported evidence

All funnel quantities are planning assumptions, not results achieved.

PROSPECTIVE CLIENTS AND BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

The workbook provisionally ranks Deloitte (4.05), Accenture (4.03) and Cognizant (3.85) highest using internal weighted estimates of potential recruitment fit. These are research priorities—not confirmed customers, approved vendors or current buyers. Large IT firms could offer recurring multi-role demand but require vendor qualification; specialist SaaS firms may present narrower, harder-to-fill roles.

Segment	Research-led approach	Qualifying question
IT / consulting	Present skill-by-hub snapshots across AI, data and workflow-platform roles	Which roles are difficult to fill with your existing channels?
AI SaaS	Show how production RAG experience differs from generic LLM exposure	What technical evidence makes a candidate submission useful?
Product SaaS	Map engineering and solutions/presales talent against product priorities	Which openings may require external search support?

Sample introduction: “I researched the Bengaluru AI talent market, particularly profiles combining Python, retrieval systems and shipped APIs. If those skills are creating bottlenecks for your team, I would value 15 minutes to understand your current hiring priorities and share relevant market observations.”

HOW I WOULD IMPROVE THE NEXT SEARCH

After every client interview, request feedback against the agreed scorecard: technical depth, domain relevance, communication, seniority and logistics. Record candidate interest and concerns separately. If multiple shortlisted candidates fail on retrieval evaluation, add a clear retrieval-quality question to the first screen and revise search terms. Discuss the change with the manager and document the result.

EXECUTION PLAN AND RESEARCH LIMITATIONS

Days 1–2: validate job order, commercial constraints and interview process. Days 3–5: verify feeder companies and build a dated candidate longlist. Days 6–8: screen interested profiles and share substantiated notes. Days 9–10: collect client feedback, refine search and review account opportunities.

Limitations: the 44-company sample is not statistically representative; role mapping is not a live vacancy count; prospect-fit scores are subjective; hiring signals must be rechecked on official career pages before outreach. The attached workbook contains the underlying company list, role matrix, assumptions, source log and sample recruitment templates.

Takeaway: effective recruitment research should change a practical decision—where to search, whom to screen, what to send to a client, or how to adjust after feedback.